

Nesrine Malik's article "*With 'AI slop' distorting our reality, the world is sleepwalking into disaster*" delivers a powerful warning: humanity is gradually losing control over both artificial intelligence and the truth itself. Malik uses the term "AI slop" to vividly describe the flood of low-quality images and videos generated by AI that now saturate the internet. These seemingly harmless pieces of content circulate widely on social media, subtly shaping how people perceive reality and weakening their ability to make sound judgments.

Malik argues that this mass of algorithm-generated visuals is alarming not only because of its sheer volume but also because of its deeper impact on meaning and understanding. These images, often crafted with appealing aesthetics and emotional tones, blur the line between reality and fiction. They seduce viewers through beauty and familiarity, while gradually numbing their senses and dulling their critical awareness. For Malik, this is not merely a technological issue but a social and psychological crisis that reflects how our ways of seeing and believing have been reshaped by the digital environment. She observes that today's social media platforms circulate two overlapping types of images: authentic records of the real world and fabricated fantasies created by AI. The boundaries between them are dissolving, and users either cannot or do not wish to distinguish between fact and fabrication. This confusion, Malik stresses, is not neutral. It carries cultural and political consequences, as it reflects the biases built into both our technologies and the societies that produce them.

Because artificial intelligence relies on existing data and images for training, it inevitably reproduces and even amplifies the prejudices already present in those materials. Malik points out that these datasets are filled with biased representations of race, gender, and culture. As a result, AI-generated visuals often idealize whiteness, traditional family structures, and gender

stereotypes. This repetition of old social hierarchies represents not progress but regression, turning AI from a neutral tool into a weapon that reinforces outdated ideologies and political narratives.

Malik describes this situation as a kind of “sleepwalking”, not because people are unaware of the problem, but because they have lost the will to act amid overwhelming information and visual overload. Surrounded by endless streams of artificial imagery, individuals drift passively, consuming what algorithms deliver without questioning the motives or systems behind them. As the real and the artificial intertwine, we can no longer fully trust what we see, yet we cannot escape their influence either. This passive acceptance, Malik suggests, is itself dangerous: in ceasing to question, we also abandon the pursuit of truth.

The real threat, then, is not that AI will replace humans, but that humans will willingly surrender their sensitivity and critical thinking to the illusions produced by algorithms. To resist the erosion caused by “AI slop,” Malik calls on us to recover our capacity for judgment, skepticism, and responsibility toward truth. Only by remaining awake and self-aware can we preserve our sense of reality and safeguard our freedom in an age of digital illusion.